Taking all steps including sanitisation to keep COVID-19 at bay: KTC MD

NT NETWORK
Margao

GANADEEP SHELDEKAR I NT



Workers sanitising a KTC bus at Margao bus stand on Saturday morning.

As Kadamba Transport Corporation (KTC) is operating its buses on state routes, its managing director has said they have been taking all measures to prevent the spread of coronavirus.

Speaking to media persons after inspecting the sanitisation drive taken up at Margao bus stand, KTC managing director Venancio Furtado spoke of the number of buses that are being used for transporting people as well as the sanitisation drive that was being carried out.

"There are around 200 buses that have been kept for public transport for which in the morning and evening they are sanitised and throughout the day, the inside of the buses are sanitised with Lyzol. Around 50 buses have also been kept only to transport migrant labourers who want to go to the train stations," he said.

He added that an additional 20 buses were kept in Margao and Porvorim in the event the health department were to ask for their assistance.

"For anyone coming to the state, if health department asks us to provide buses, they are ready to be used to shift people to Hospicio or Asilo as required," said Furtado.

Similarly, at the Dabolim airport, Vasco depot has kept 20 buses for travellers coming by flights. And for those that are brought from other states, Furtado said that 20 Volvo sleeper and luxury buses were ready with provisions for sanitisation.

"When the buses reach their destination, they are sanitised with a spray that is sent from here in the bus and only then allowed to return. We give water, snacks like fruits, biscuit or sandwich to the travellers so that they don't buy from outside. The drivers have separate provisions for food and drinking where they are told not to eat from outside," said Furtado.

He also added that the KTC would help private bus owners to sanitise their buses as well, both inside and outside, so that people within the state were also able to use the buses without any worry.

Celebrate Eid at home, avoid public gatherings, appeal police

NT NETWORK
Panaji

Goa police held meetings with Muslim community leaders advising them to urge the community members to celebrate Eid at home.

According to the information, police inspectors and DySPs have held meetings with community leaders throughout the state advising them to tell everyone to celebrate Eid at home this year.

"This year, on the occasion of Eid Goa police urges all to celebrate (Eid) with loved ones at home. My colleagues are reaching out to provide all necessary guidance and with an appeal to avoid public gatherings. #StayHomeStaySafe Let's pray for humanity", Goa police posted on its social media account on Saturday.

SP Shobhit Saksena said that it was the initiative of IGP Jaspal Singh to interact with community leaders and to request them to celebrate Eid without large gathering.

"Our police officers have held meetings with community leaders in the state, advising them to tell everyone to celebrate Eid at home this year and not to go out in public places in large numbers as we are still in lockdown," said Saksena, adding that, "during lockdown the religious and cultural gathering as well as religious places are closed". He said that meetings are to ensure that Eid is celebrated at home and that due precaution is taken.

Meanwhile, South Goa Superintendent of Police Arvind Gawas on Saturday said that police stations in South Goa had organised meeting with Muslim brethren and appealed them to observe Eid with simplicity, while offering prayers at home.

He further added that it is mandatory on the occasion of Eid that people should stay at home and maintain social distancing. He appealed to Muslims not to visit graveyards but pray for their departed relatives while staying at home.

A member of Muslim community said that "we are observing Ramzan this year in extraordinary circumstances and, therefore, Eid should be celebrated in a simple manner." "When the entire month of Ramzan has been spent praying at home due to the lockdown, what is the point of buying new clothes," he added.

Hospital escape incident: charge-sheet filed

NT NETWORK
Margao

Fatorda police have filed the charge-sheet against criminal Gabbi Fernandes, aged 23, a resident of Ambeudak-Sanvordem, arrested by Curchorem police after he had escaped from police custody from Margao Hospicio hospital. He was produced before Judicial Magistrate First Class (JMFC) and remanded to judicial custody. At present, he is in Colvale jail.

He had escaped after assaulting policemen on duty. Fatorda police had registered the offence under sections 353 and 224 of IPC for assaulting public servant while discharging duty and escaping from the hospital. The case was registered by Fatorda police since the incident of escape took place in the jurisdiction of Fatorda police station.

Two police constables, who were posted on duty at Margao Hospicio hospital where alleged accused was undergoing treatment, were suspended since the alleged accused had escaped.

24-yr-old held for outraging modesty of minor girl

NT NETWORK
Margao

A 24-year-old youth of Pedda-Margao was arrested by Margao police on Saturday for allegedly outraging modesty of a minor girl, aged 11 and for assaulting her. The minor girl was taken to Margao Hospicio hospital for medical check-up.

Police sub inspector of Margao police station Vibhavari Gaonker, when contacted, said that Marfon Andrade, aged 24, has been arrested under sections 354, 323, 504 of IPC and section 8(2) of Goa Children's Act and also under Protection of Children from Sexual Offences (POCSO) Act.

After his arrest, the alleged accused was produced before Judicial Magistrate First Class (JMFC), Margao and three days' remand was taken to conduct investigation.

According to PSI Gaonker, the complaint was lodged by the mother of victim girl alleging that on May 22 evening the youth slapped her daughter and further using criminal force outraged her modesty. He also caught hold of her and abused her, the complainant alleged.

Police said that after conducting legal formalities, the alleged accused was arrested and lodged in police custody. Police have recorded the statement in the case.

Labourer succumbs

NT NETWORK
Vasco

A 21-year-old labourer died after accidentally sustaining grievous injuries while unloading concrete blocks from a truck at Birla-Zuarinagar.

As per available information from Verna police, the deceased, identified as Shashi Kumar Joshi, was unloading concrete blocks from a truck when the carrier of the truck, which was raised, came down crashing on his head.

He sustained grievous injuries and was rushed to Goa Medical College (GMC) and Hospital at Bambolim. He breathed his last while undergoing treatment on May 22. A case of unnatural death has been registered by the Verna police. Police sub-inspector Kiran Naik is further investigating the case.

Curchorem fish vendors 'ditch' market premises for roadside vending

NT NETWORK
Curchorem

SAMIR BHAT | NT



The newly-repaired fish market of Curchorem lies half empty as most vendors prefer selling fish from roadsides.

Following the lockdown, there has been a huge rise in the number of fish vendors in Curchorem area, who are making a brisk business with limited availability of fish. However, this has also given rise to concerns over health risk in the wake of the COVID-19 pandemic.

Curchorem Cacora Municipal Council (CCMC) has repaired the existing fish market by expending around Rs 16 lakh. Not only the roof is repaired but also proper seating arrangement for the fish vendors has been done. There is drainage system besides provision of electricity and water.

Curchorem fish market used to remain packed from morning till noon as people from Curchorem, Cacora and surrounding areas would flock the market to buy fish.

However, now several fish vendors have started selling fish at different spots in Curchorem area. This has become a health and hygiene concern.

As per information, except for six or seven fish vendors, rest all have shifted to roadsides as they claim that the customers prefer purchasing fish from the vendors who sit along the roads rather than in the market.

Chairperson of CCMC Balkrishna Hodarkar, when contacted, said that he is aware of the situation as he has received several complaints from the fish vendors that they are compelled to shift to roadsides because the customers do not frequent the fish market.

"We shall initiate action against the fish vendors carrying out business in open area in the CCMC jurisdiction. They will either have to shift back to the fish market or stop their activity. Also, fish selling will be allowed in private shops provided the vendors posses trade licence," he said.

Milind urged to take up 'signature' project in Vasco

NT NETWORK
Vasco

BJP state executive committee member and social worker Chandrakant Gawas has urged Minister for Urban Development Milind Naik to take up the 'Golden Jubilee signature project' in Vasco through Goa State Urban Development Agency (GSUDA).

Speaking to this daily, Gawas said that the work of the long-awaited Golden Jubilee signature project in Vasco was supposed to get started after laying of the cornerstone in March 2013, but the project has remained 'grounded' due to some technical reasons.

The project is meant to boost the revenue of the council.

"I request the Minister for Urban Development Naik to start the long-awaited project through GSUDA so that it can be completed without facing shortage of funds," said Gawas. He has also decided to write to the director of municipal administration to fast-track the project so that it could be completed without any delay.

Meanwhile, Gawas also urged the Minister for Transport and Panchayats Mauvin Godinho to give attention to issues like sewerage connectivity, regularisation of houses and water woes in New Vaddem.

"People in New Vaddem have big expectations from Godinho where he can resolve issues as regards sewerage connectivity, regularisation of houses and water woes which are being faced by the people. Goidnho should get these issues resolved so that people can heave a sigh of relief," he said.

He also highlighted about irregular collection of garbage in New Vaddem.

"The councillors need to pay immediate attention to this issue as they represent the people from their respective wards," Gawas stated. He also urged the elected representatives to give attention to repairs of internal roads which are lying in bad shape.





Stranded people approach Calangute MLA's office for help with travel permit formalities

NT NETWORK
Calangute

More than 500 tourists stranded in the beach belt and even Goans stuck in other states are in touch with Calangute MLA's office for help and quick facilitation of collector's permit for them to travel.

Sources from the MLA's office in Calangute told this daily that stranded migrants and tourists approach the office on daily basis seeking help as regards formalities for their travel with multiple restrictions being in place due to COVID-19.

"We get more than 500 people a day for help in getting the collector's permit to travel in their vehicles or by hiring tourist vehicles. There are more than 500 tourists stranded in Morjim, Anjuna, Vagator, Tiracol, living in rented rooms. Even Goans who are stranded in Mumbai, Belagavi, Tamil Nadu, Karnataka, Rajasthan, Lucknow are calling up our office to get help with availing the permit. We keep getting calls from 5 am till midnight," sources stated.

Migrants and stranded tourists are being helped in getting the collector's permit so that they are able to travel by their vehicles, bikes and buses to their states for which more than 1000 permits were being sought.

Sources said that "even buses are being arranged for migrants to travel to Karmali and Margao railway stations; some migrants do not have mobile phone to get SMS update but we manage it all for them."

It is learnt that shack owners have arranged buses to take their staff to thier states. Almost 25 buses have left by taking permits from those states to travel, it was stated.

VMC nearly ready for monsoon with most works completed

NT NETWORK
Valpoi

The Valpoi Municipal Council (VMC) on Friday claimed that it is ready to handle this year's monsoon as it has desilted nearly 90 per cent of the town's major nullahs as part of its pre-monsoon work, ahead of the deadline.

VMC chairperson Aktar Shah also claimed it has finished desilting work of major nullah near Valpoi bridge and also stretch of nullah behind Unity High School and disilted small rivulets in the wards which used to get flooded during monsoon. Besides performing frontline duties in the battle against coronavirus (Covid-19), the VMC had also launched the desilting drive to declog water bodies.

"VMC completed 90 per cent of pre-monsoon work except in ward 4 which will be finished within two days. Desilting of nullahs was taken up this year considering the fear of flooding during monsoon. Even some of the spots which were identified were also rectified and hopefully this monsoon no area will be flooded," Shah stated.

The VMC's pre-monsoon work involves overall cleaning of the town's stormwater drains and residents appreciated the work carried out. However, some locals urged VMC to cover the open drains which may pose threat to the pedestrians and motorists during monsoon.

Chandor resident's body fished out

NT NETWORK
Margao

A 34-year-old resident of Cotta-Chandor, who had gone missing since May 20, was found dead. Maina Curtorim police said that the body was found floating in Kushawati river and was fished out with the help of fire brigade personnel, Margao.

Police disclosed the name of the deceased as A Gomes. Police have sent the body to Margao Hospicio hospital.

Meanwhile, another person, aged 40, was found dead near old railway station road.

Margao police said that the person's identity was not known and the body has been sent to Goa Medical College and Hospital, Bambolim.

WITH GRATEFUL THANKS TO
Alessandro Bafico



Sethu is deeply grateful to **Alessandro Bafico**, who passed away in October 2017, for his immeasurable generosity in bequeathing his properties and houses at **Donvaddo, Saligao, Goa (S.Ns 159/10, 159/10A, 159/11, 159/12, 159/13, 157/19)** to **Sethu** for the future expansion and upgradation of its work. After the completion of a lengthy legal process, thanks to the indefatigable efforts of **Ralph de Sousa,** the Executor of the Will, Sethu has taken over charge of the property and has started its services there on 12th May 2020. Thank you **Alessandro** for such a fabulous birthday present as Sethu completes 15 radiant years on 1st June 2020. We pledge to keep your spirit of kindness and compassion gloriously alive.